

Systems Engineering Squad: Progress Metrics

- **Current Progress: 5%** (Commencing Week 1, Day 2 of the 3-Month Bootcamp).
- **Current Focus:** Week 1 Mandate — Memory Hygiene, RAI (Resource Acquisition Is Initialization), and Smart Pointer Architecture.

The Daily Drop Blueprint

Title: Systems Engineering Squad: Week 1, Tuesday - RAI & Smart Pointer Architecture

Section A: Today's Materials (The Synthesis Mandate)

You must synthesize the information from all sources below to complete today's execution mandate. Do not consult outside tutorials. (*Note: As C++ lacks a Scrimba module, you will rely entirely on enterprise documentation and industry lectures*).

1. The Video Drills (Watch These First)

- **External Anchor 1:** [YouTube: The Cherno - SMART POINTERS in C++](#) (*The definitive guide to unique_ptr, shared_ptr, and weak_ptr*).
- **External Anchor 2:** [YouTube: CppCon - Back to Basics: Smart Pointers](#) (*Mandatory enterprise theory on object ownership and memory lifetimes*).
- **External Video 1:** [YouTube: C++ Weekly - Stop Using new and delete](#) (*Required viewing to understand the strict memory bans applied to your code today*).

2. Required Technical Documentation

- **Primary Architecture Doc:** [LearnCpp.com - std::unique_ptr and std::make_unique](#) (*The foundation of modern memory isolation*).
- **Specific Syntax Doc:** [cppreference.com - std::shared_ptr](#) (*Read specifically how the atomic reference counter operates*).
- **Configuration Doc:** [Clang Docs: AddressSanitizer](#) (*Required to prove your program is mathematically leak-free*).

3. Engineering Assets

- **Architecture Asset:** [GitHub: Standard CMake C++ Boilerplate](#) (*Reference for how enterprise C++ directories are structured*).
- **LLM Prompting Asset:** [OpenAI Official Guide: Prompt Engineering](#) (*Use this to ask the LLM to decode and explain complex Valgrind or AddressSanitizer stack traces*).

Section B: The Execution Mandate (9:00 AM - 2:00 PM)

1. Execution Summary (TL;DR)

Objective: Abandon legacy C-style memory management. Build a dynamic, node-based data structure (e.g., a Singly Linked List) utilizing strict RAII principles, where memory is autonomously managed by `std::unique_ptr` and `std::shared_ptr` to mathematically guarantee zero leaks.

2. The Workflow:

- **9:00 AM - 10:00 AM (Learning):** Watch the Smart Pointer drills and CppCon lectures. Read the `cppreference` documentation on the overhead costs of atomic reference counting in shared pointers.
- **10:00 AM - 1:00 PM (Building):**
 - **Action 1 (Setup/Init):** Initialize your GCC/Clang environment. Configure your `CMakeLists.txt` to aggressively compile with the `-Wall`, `-Wextra`, `-Werror`, and `-fsanitize=address` flags.
 - **Action 2 (Core Logic):** Architect a custom `LinkedList` class containing a nested `Node` struct. You must build methods to `append()`, `print()`, and `delete()` nodes.
 - **Action 3 (The Memory Mandate):** The `Node` pointers inside your linked list must be strictly managed using `std::unique_ptr`. You must also implement an external class that safely observes a node using a `std::shared_ptr`.
- **The Non-Negotiable Rules:**
 1. **The Raw Pointer Ban:** You are explicitly forbidden from using the `new` and `delete` keywords. You may only allocate memory using `std::make_unique` and `std::make_shared`. Any pull request containing raw pointer ownership is an automatic failure.
 2. **The Leak Ban:** Your compilation process must utilize `AddressSanitizer`. If your terminal outputs a single byte of leaked memory, double-free, or dangling pointer upon execution, your build fails the enterprise standard.
- **1:00 PM - 1:30 PM (Hygiene):** Verify your code compiles flawlessly under the `-Werror` flag. Push your codebase, including the clean `CMakeLists.txt`, to your GitHub repository.
- **1:30 PM - 2:00 PM (LinkedIn):** Draft a technical summary of your execution. Detail the architectural differences between C++ RAII (Resource Acquisition Is Initialization) and standard Garbage Collection found in Python/Java. You must hyperlink your ProSensia admit card within the post text.



Section C: Submission Protocol (Due strictly by 2:00 PM)

- **Step 1 (The Kanban Board):** Verify that this specific task card is shifted to the "Under Review" column on your team board.

- **Step 2 (The Assignments Module):** Navigate directly to today's entry in the platform's independent Assignment block. Paste both your public GitHub Repository URL and your live LinkedIn Post URL into the designated submission form fields.
- **Operational Note:** All grading and technical feedback loops operate through this portal. Do not DM Management your links.